



Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad  
香港語言學奧林匹克

en

## Seventh Hong Kong Linguistics Olympiad

February 23<sup>rd</sup>, 2025

Solutions

### Problem 1.

- Word order: 

|   |                   |     |                              |
|---|-------------------|-----|------------------------------|
| S | O <sub>Noun</sub> | Loc | V-Y-Z-X <sub>0,Pronoun</sub> |
|---|-------------------|-----|------------------------------|

|                       |
|-----------------------|
| Noun-X <sub>pos</sub> |
|-----------------------|
- X: **-ñ** = 1SG, **-ne** = 3SG, **-me** = 1PL
- A and B = A B **spä** (**spä** placed after the first word of B)
- Verbs:

|   |         | V <sub>tr</sub> | V <sub>intr</sub> | V <sub>caus</sub>           |
|---|---------|-----------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
|   | Past    |                 |                   | <b>i &gt; ai; u &gt; au</b> |
| V | Past    |                 | <b>ā &gt; a</b>   |                             |
|   | Present |                 | <b>ā &gt; o</b>   |                             |
| Y | Present | <b>an</b>       | <b>e*</b>         | <b>äsk</b>                  |
|   | Past    | <b>ā</b>        | <b>ā</b>          | <b>a</b>                    |

\* **e > o / oC<sub>0</sub> \_**

| Z   | Present           |                                    | Past              |                                    |
|-----|-------------------|------------------------------------|-------------------|------------------------------------|
|     | V <sub>intr</sub> | V <sub>tr</sub> /V <sub>caus</sub> | V <sub>intr</sub> | V <sub>tr</sub> /V <sub>caus</sub> |
| 1SG | <b>mar</b>        | <b>au</b>                          | <b>mai</b>        | <b>wa</b>                          |
| 3SG | <b>tär</b>        | <b>äṃ</b>                          | <b>te</b>         | Ø                                  |
| 1PL | <b>mtär</b>       | <b>em</b>                          | <b>mte</b>        | <b>mo</b>                          |
| 3PL | <b>ntär</b>       | <b>eṃ</b>                          | <b>nte</b>        | <b>re</b>                          |

$V_{intr} = \text{intr.}, V_{tr} = \text{tr.}, V_{caus} = \text{caus.}$

- Noun: 

|                   |
|-------------------|
| Stem-Case-Postpos |
|-------------------|

(a) Case

|           | Nom.SG   | Acc.SG    | Nom.PL     | Acc.PL     |
|-----------|----------|-----------|------------|------------|
| animate   | <b>e</b> | <b>eṃ</b> | <b>i</b>   | <b>eṃ</b>  |
| inanimate | <b>e</b> | Ø         | <b>i</b>   | <b>äṃ</b>  |
|           | <b>o</b> | <b>ai</b> | <b>aiñ</b> | <b>aiṃ</b> |

(b) Postpos (if present, Case = Acc) : **meṃ** = Ablative, **ne** = Locative

13. *My words misled the hearts.*
14. *The flower gladdened him.*
15. *I cross the pond in his village.*
16. *We seek our body and stumble from the boats.*
17. *The boats hide in the houses.*
- (b) 18. **kektseñ-ñ taukawa**
19. **eñkwi šamaškeṃ ritäre oskai špä kätkäre**
20. **pyäpyaiñ kolmaimem-me kloyontär srukentär špä kaumaiṃne**
21. **šamäne kattäkeṃ pläntäskäm**
22. **arañci pälskanem-ne plontontär špä**